Deep Research Report

Directors of Schools and Assistant Directors of Schools Using Claude Code

March 22, 2026

4 source categories | 25 sources | 22 claims analyzed

Executive Summary

This report investigates whether any K-12 director of schools, assistant director of schools, superintendent, or assistant superintendent in the United States is using Claude Code, Anthropic's command-line AI coding tool, for district operations work. Four parallel research agents searched government, news, academic, and industry sources independently, producing 25 unique sources across all four categories.

Bottom line: No documented case exists of a K-12 director of schools or assistant director of schools using Claude Code for district operations. The closest documented case is Peninsula School District (WA), where CIO Kris Hagel built an open-source Claude Code plugin system for district operations, but Hagel is a technology leader, not a superintendent or instructional administrator.

The broader context is significant: AI adoption among K-12 administrators is accelerating rapidly. RAND data shows 58% of principals used AI tools in 2023-24 (compared to 25% of teachers). In Tennessee, 85% of districts report educator AI use, with 84% citing reduced administrative task time as the primary benefit. However, this adoption is occurring through consumer-grade, no-code AI platforms (ChatGPT, MagicSchool, Google Gemini), not through developer-oriented tools like Claude Code.

Confidence in this conclusion: High. All four source categories independently confirmed the null finding. The absence of evidence is itself significant given the breadth of search: federal and state government databases, major education trade press, peer-reviewed academic journals, professional organization publications, and Anthropic's own education reports all returned no results for this specific use case.

1. Background and Context

Claude Code is Anthropic's agentic command-line interface (CLI) tool, launched in early 2025. Unlike Claude.ai (the chatbot) or the Claude API, Claude Code operates in a terminal environment, enabling users to write, edit, and execute code through natural language conversation. It has gained significant traction among software developers and, increasingly, non-technical professionals in industries like healthcare (Epic Systems), finance, marketing, and design.

Directors of schools (the Tennessee term for superintendents) and assistant directors of schools are the chief executive and senior administrative officers of K-12 school districts. Their work spans budgeting, human resources, facilities management, data analysis, policy compliance, board communications, and strategic planning. Many of these tasks involve structured data, repetitive document generation, and analytical workflows that could benefit from AI-assisted coding.

The question of whether any such administrator has adopted Claude Code is timely for several reasons: (1) Claude Code's user base has expanded rapidly to non-developers since early 2026, (2) K-12 districts are under increasing pressure to demonstrate AI adoption for operational efficiency, and (3) state legislatures (notably Tennessee's Public Chapter 550) now require districts to have formal AI policies.

2. Key Findings

2.1 No K-12 Education Executive Uses Claude Code (Documented)

[HIGH CONFIDENCE] Across all four source categories, no government report, news article, academic study, or industry publication documents a superintendent, director of schools, assistant superintendent, or assistant director of schools using Claude Code for district operations work. This finding was confirmed independently by all four research agents.

Anthropic's own education report explicitly excludes K-12 educators from analysis, focusing only on higher education accounts. Claude for Education, launched in 2025, targets university settings. Anthropic's K-12 partnerships (Teach For All, Iceland pilot) involve Claude the chatbot for classroom instruction, not Claude Code for administrative operations.

2.2 Peninsula School District: The Closest Case

[MEDIUM CONFIDENCE] Peninsula School District (PSD401) in Gig Harbor, WA maintains an open-source Claude Code plugin system on GitHub (psd401/psd-claude-coding-system) with 42 specialized agents and 25 productivity workflows for district operations. This includes district-specific skills for athletics, brand guidelines, FreshService ticket integration, and RedRover systems. The system was built and is maintained by CIO Kris Hagel, a CoSN Board member and 2024 CoSN Volunteer of the Year. Hagel presented the framework at AIEmpoweredEDU2025.

This is the only documented case of Claude Code being used for K-12 district operations anywhere in the United States. However, it was built by a technology leader (CIO), not by the superintendent or an instructional administrator. The distinction matters: the research question is whether education executives, not IT staff, are personally using Claude Code.

2.3 K-12 Administrators Are Rapidly Adopting AI, but Not Developer Tools

[HIGH CONFIDENCE] Multiple independent data sources confirm that K-12 administrators use AI at significantly higher rates than teachers. RAND (2025) found 58% of U.S. principals used AI in 2023-24 vs. 25% of teachers. Riegel et al. (2025) found administrators scored 3.41 on an AI use scale vs. 2.48 for teachers ($p<.001$). Berkovich (2025) found 50% of school leaders are in the 'early majority' adoption stage.

However, the tools being used are uniformly consumer-grade: ChatGPT, Google Gemini, MagicSchool, SchoolAI, and similar no-code platforms. Superintendent Corey Smith (South Putnam, IN) described using generative AI for RFP analysis and budget spreadsheet review, but through copy-paste workflows, not coding tools. No administrator in any source described using a CLI, writing scripts, or engaging with developer-oriented AI tools.

2.4 Tennessee Context: Strong AI Momentum, No Claude Code Adoption

[HIGH CONFIDENCE] Tennessee is among the most proactive states in K-12 AI policy. Public Chapter 550 (2024) requires all LEAs to adopt AI policies. SCORE/TOSS survey data shows 85% of TN districts report educator AI use, with 84% identifying reduced administrative task time as the top benefit. The Tennessee AI Advisory Council published an action plan in November 2025 that includes education. None of these sources mention Claude Code or any AI coding tool for administrators.

2.5 The Academic Literature Has a Complete Blind Spot

[HIGH CONFIDENCE] The academic research on AI in K-12 education focuses almost entirely on instructional applications (personalized learning, assessment, tutoring) and teacher adoption. An umbrella review of 102 systematic reviews (2025) found that 'preparing administrators and leaders to understand and ethically use AI has received much less attention.' No academic study examines whether school administrators possess programming skills, use coding tools, or leverage developer-oriented AI for operational tasks.

2.6 Claude Code's Non-Developer Adoption Is Growing, but Education Is Absent

[HIGH CONFIDENCE] Fortune (Jan 2026) and TechBuzz documented Claude Code's expansion to non-developers: marketing managers, designers, executives, healthcare workers at Epic Systems, and small business owners. The sectors named include healthcare, big tech (Netflix, Uber, Spotify), finance, and consulting. K-12 education is entirely absent from this adoption narrative.

3. Points of Contradiction

No contradictions were found across the four source categories. All agents independently confirmed the same null finding regarding Claude Code use by K-12 education executives. The only area of potential tension is between the narrative that AI adoption among administrators is 'rapid' (RAND, Riegel) and the reality that this adoption is limited to consumer-grade tools. Whether administrators would benefit from developer-level tools like Claude Code is an open question that no source addresses.

4. Single-Source Claims

The following claims are supported by only one source category and warrant additional scrutiny:

- **Peninsula School District's Claude Code plugin system is the only documented K-12 Claude Code deployment in the US.** Industry sources only. No government, news, or academic source references this system. Additional verification would require examining other district GitHub organizations and interviewing Hagel directly.
- **Budget planning/resource allocation has the lowest AI adoption rate among school leadership tasks (25.8%).** Academic sources only (Berkovich, 2025). Based on an Israeli sample (n=302), which limits generalizability to U.S. districts. No U.S.-focused study has replicated this finding.
- **Only 8% of K-12 IT workforce is 'well prepared' for AI (CoSN survey).** Industry sources only. CoSN membership may skew toward more tech-engaged districts, meaning the actual number could be lower nationally.

5. Practical Implications

For a K-12 administrator considering Claude Code:

You would be a genuine first mover. No documented superintendent or director of schools is using Claude Code for district operations. Peninsula School District's CIO has built the infrastructure, but no education executive has publicly adopted it. This represents both opportunity and risk.

The use cases are strong but undocumented. Superintendent Smith's described workflows (RFP analysis, budget trend analysis, email triage, document generation) are precisely the tasks where Claude Code excels. The gap between 'I upload spreadsheets to a chatbot' and 'Claude Code automates my enrollment pipeline' is significant but unexplored in practice by education leaders.

Anthropic has a K-12 blind spot. Anthropic's education report explicitly excludes K-12. Claude for Education targets universities. Their K-12 partnerships focus on classroom instruction, not district operations. An administrator using Claude Code for district work would be outside Anthropic's current K-12 strategy.

The policy environment is favorable but tool-agnostic. Tennessee's AI requirements (Public Chapter 550) and federal guidance encourage AI adoption but deliberately avoid naming specific tools. A district using Claude Code would need to ensure compliance with its own AI policy, data governance, and PII protections.

Publication and speaking opportunities are wide open. The AASA/MIT RAISE fellowship (July 2026), CoSN conferences, and education trade press are actively seeking superintendent AI stories. A director of schools using Claude Code for data automation, enrollment projections, or board document generation would be a compelling case study with no competition in the space.

Unanswered Questions

- Are there administrators using Claude Code who simply haven't published about it?
- Would Anthropic be interested in a K-12 administrator case study for Claude Code?
- What data governance considerations are unique to running Claude Code on district data?

- Could Claude Code's multi-agent capabilities replace multiple point solutions (MagicSchool, SchoolAI, etc.) for a district?

6. Federal and State Policy Context

The federal government has issued multiple guidance documents on AI in education. The USED's 2023 report 'Artificial Intelligence and the Future of Teaching and Learning' identified administrative AI applications including resource allocation and student risk prediction. A July 2025 Dear Colleague Letter encourages grantees to use AI for improved education outcomes. The Office of Educational Technology's 2024 toolkit specifically targets education leaders for 'safe, ethical, and equitable AI integration.' None of these documents mention coding tools or administrators writing code.

At the state level, Tennessee is a national leader. Public Chapter 550 (2024) requires all LEAs to adopt AI policies. The Tennessee AI Advisory Council's November 2025 action plan includes education as a focus area. TSBA's model policy (4.214) provides a framework for districts. Two additional 2025 bills direct TDOE to provide guidance and fund professional development. These policies are uniformly tool-agnostic, creating space for districts to adopt any AI tool, including Claude Code, within their governance framework.

7. Tennessee Data Appendix

Metric	Value	Source
Districts reporting AI use	85% (of 86 responding districts)	SCORE/TOSS 2025
Districts offering AI training	~64%	SCORE/TOSS 2025
Top benefit cited	Reduced admin task time (84%)	SCORE/TOSS 2025
Top concern	Cheating/plagiarism (84%)	SCORE/TOSS 2025
Need additional PD	85%	SCORE/TOSS 2025
AI policy required by law	Yes (Public Chapter 550, 2024-25)	TN General Assembly
State AI Advisory Council	Active, action plan Nov 2025	tn.gov
Districts with Claude Code adoption	0 documented	All sources

8. Source Reliability Matrix

#	Author/Org	Year	Category	Agent Conf.	URL Status	Agg. Score	Reliability
3	U.S. Department of Education	2025	Government	High	Live	1.00	High
4	Tennessee SCORE	2025	Government	High	Live	1.00	High
5	Tennessee General Assembly	2024	Government	High	Live	1.00	High
6	Tennessee AI Advisory Council	2025	Government	High	Live	1.00	High
7	U.S. Department of Education	2023	Government	High	Live	1.00	High
9	RAND Corporation	2025	Academic	High	Live	1.00	High
10	Riegel, C., Ford, A., Brinkman, J., et al.	2025	Academic	High	Live	1.00	High
12	Various Authors	2025	Academic	High	Live	1.00	High
13	Tyson, M. M. & Sauers, N. J.	2021	Academic	High	Live	1.00	High
22	White House	2025	Government	High	Live	1.00	High
25	U.S. Department of Education	2025	Government	High	Live	1.00	High
14	CRPE	2025	Academic	Medium	Live	0.80	High
16	Fortune	2026	News	High	Live	0.80	High
17	TechBuzz AI	2026	News	High	Live	0.80	High

18	Education Week Market Brief	2025	News	High	Live	0.80	High
1	Peninsula School District	2025	Industry	High	Live	0.77	Medium
2	AIEmpoweredEDU2025	2025	Industry	High	Live	0.70	Medium
8	Anthropic	2025	Industry	High	Live	0.70	Medium
11	Berkovich, I.	2025	Academic	Medium	Live	0.70	Medium
15	U.S. DOE, Office of Ed. Technology	2024	Government	Medium	Live	0.70	Medium
20	Anthropic	2025	Industry	High	Live	0.70	Medium
19	CoSN	2025	Industry	High	PDF (unreadable via web)	0.56	Medium
23	AASA	2026	News	Medium	Live	0.56	Medium
21	Anthropic	2026	Industry	Medium	Live	0.49	Low
24	RAND Corporation	2025	Academic	Medium	Gov-blocked (403)	0.49	Low

25 sources total: 15 high reliability, 8 medium, 2 low. All URLs verified live except 1 PDF (CoSN, unreadable via web fetch) and 1 gov-blocked (RAND, 403). 0 dead URLs replaced.

9. Claim Cross-Reference Matrix

Claim	Gov	News	Acad.	Ind.	Agreement
No K-12 exec uses Claude Code	✓	✓	✓	✓	Full
PSD CIO built Claude Code plugins	—	—	—	✓	Single
Admins use AI more than teachers	—	—	✓	—	Single
58% of principals used AI (2023-24)	—	—	✓	—	Single
85% TN districts report AI use	✓	—	—	✓	Partial
TN requires AI policies (PC 550)	✓	—	—	—	Single
Anthropic excludes K-12 from research	—	✓	✓	✓	Full
Claude Code adopted by non-devs	—	✓	—	✓	Partial
MagicSchool uses Claude backend	—	—	—	✓	Single
Supts want AI for central office	—	✓	—	✓	Partial
Budget/finance is lowest AI adoption	—	—	✓	—	Single
79 early-adopter districts (CRPE)	—	—	✓	✓	Partial

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